

STAGE SIX • COMMUNICATION: SPEAKING, READING & WRITING

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Six • Communication: Speaking, Reading & Writing

PURPOSE

Stage Six is unusually interaction-heavy for its size — role-play, live speaking, recording, and rotating facilitation all appear across its six sessions. This document covers every activity across the Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that genuinely changes shape between formats.

A few activities in this stage (notably conflict role-play and impromptu speaking) carry genuine emotional weight regardless of format; the notes below focus on logistics, but the sensitivity guidance in the companion Facilitator Notes / Script document applies equally in both formats.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Subject Line Swap (FIRST I1)	Pairs physically swap papers or turn laptops toward each other.	Breakout rooms of 2, subject line pasted into a private chat between the pair rather than the whole room's chat.
Paired Playback Review (FIRST I5)	Partners watch each other's phone screen directly.	Use screen share in breakout rooms, or have participants send their recording directly to their partner beforehand and discuss live.
Structured Mini-Debate (FIRST I23)	Teams stand facing each other across the room.	Breakout rooms per team for prep, then reconvene in the main room for the actual debate so the full group can observe.
Relay Presentation (FIRST I28)	Groups physically stand together at the front of the room, handing off verbally and physically.	Groups share one screen (one member's, passed via "make host" or shared slides) with a clear verbal handoff cue between speakers.
Random Prompt Circle (FIRST I29)	Genuine physical circle, prompt cards drawn from a hat.	Use the "raise hand" queue or call names in order; use a random name picker tool or a shared randomized list for prompt assignment.
Role-Play Pairs (FIRST I42, I64)	Pairs find a quiet corner or face each other directly.	Breakout rooms of 2. Consider recording (with consent) for the pair's own private review afterward, since there's no natural in-room observer.
Rotating Facilitator (FIRST I45)	Facilitator role passes via a physical object (a marker, a card) placed in front of the new facilitator.	Facilitator role passes via the "spotlight" or by the outgoing facilitator explicitly naming the next person; a shared visual cue (renaming the person's screen tile) helps track whose turn it is.
Cross-Cultural Perspective Panel (FIRST I17)	Volunteers sit at the front; open floor discussion afterward.	Volunteers can pre-record a short clip if live sharing feels like too much pressure on video, then the group discusses after watching together.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use "raise hand" or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For sessions with heavy role-play (Session 4 especially), a hybrid format works best if remote and in-person participants are paired within their own group rather than mixed — mixed pairs where one person is physically present and one is a video tile tend to feel genuinely unequal for both.

For recording exercises (I5, I21, I27), remote participants already have a natural advantage since they're recording on their own device in their own space — no adaptation needed there, but ensure in-person participants have a similarly private, quiet space available rather than recording in front of the full group.